

there is something behind the enthusiasm. The job-giver or the bank official may then be willing to forego some formal requirement. *Focused* enthusiasm, however, is truly irresistible. Let us see how to focus your enthusiasm when you apply for a job. We apply the process to getting a job, but you will see the many ways in which it can be applied to other situations.

Prepare a carefully written statement of reasons why you should have the job. You may not have been asked to prepare a resumé, but the written statement focuses the information in your own mind.

*State your education.* Name the schools you have attended, the courses you took. Tell, especially, of your education outside school, as in night courses. Enlarge on any kind of education which particularly prepared you to handle the job you seek.

*State your experience.* Give names of employers, dates of employment. Be sure to bring out experience which helps to qualify you in the eyes of the new, prospective employer.

*Give references.* Choose them with care. Choose them, if possible, in relation to what they can tell the prospective employer about you as *his* employee.

*State the job you want.* Sometimes, when applying for a job with a large company, you may not get the job you want because they are more interested in filling a vacancy somewhere else. Whether you take the other job is a matter of judgment. Nevertheless, focus your enthusiasm on a particular job when you are an applicant.

*State your qualifications for that particular job.* When you focus on the job you want, it may result in the company "finding" a vacancy where you want one to exist—or expanding the staff to include you.

*Show you know a good deal about the prospective employer's business.* Do not do this in a prying way, but show you know something about the market, sources of supply and customers, for instance, in his "trade." An hour or two with that trade's magazines—available in libraries—can teach you a great deal.

*Offer to go to work on probation.* Make it clear that this offer is based on your confidence in your ability to fill the needs of the job, your confidence that you will be permanently employed once you are given a chance to show you have what it takes. (Even this should be put into writing, whether required or not, to fix it in your mind.)